



Health Beverage OEM/ODM - The Complete Guide

From Concept to Shelf: Your Essential Handbook for Contract Manufacturing

YuKoLi Technology



From Concept to Formula: Custom R&D Process

In health beverage contract manufacturing, the traditional cycle from brand concept to production-ready formulation takes 3-4 weeks. YuKoLi compresses this to 3-7 days through a dual-track approach: standardized formulation platform combined with customized fine-tuning. The process unfolds in six steps: requirement briefing (brand provides concept direction, target demographic, and budget) ? formula proposal (R&D team matches base framework from 500+ proven formulas) ? flavor tuning (adjust sweetness, mouthfeel, aroma per target market preferences) ? sampling (3-7 days, with sensory evaluation reports and nutritional analysis) ? formula lock (confirmation followed by pilot scale validation) ? specification finalization (packaging, label compliance, shelf-life testing). The most critical step is step two - the richer the OEM's formula database, the faster the sampling shifts from weeks to days.



Compliance & Certification: One-Stop Clearance

One of the biggest challenges for cross-border functional food brands is navigating different target market compliance barriers. For US FDA: imported dietary supplements require facility registration and product listing; non-compliant products face customs detention, import alerts, and fines. HACCP is the international benchmark for food safety management, covering full-chain hazard analysis from raw material receipt through production to storage and transport. ISO 22000 integrates HACCP with ISO quality management systems, covering broader management elements. Halal certification has become mandatory in Middle Eastern, Southeast Asian, and Muslim-populated Western markets. YuKoLi holds all four certifications. Brands don't need to coordinate with multiple certification bodies - from formula review to label compliance, YuKoLi handles everything end-to-end. This means shelf-entry time for US retailers drops from 6-8 months to just 3-4 months.



Manufacturing: Flexible Lines & Elastic Capacity

The most common capacity dilemma for brands: new product launches need small batches for market testing (500-5,000 units), while trending products need rapid scale-up to 500,000+ units per month. Traditional OEM factories typically force a binary choice - large factories refuse small orders, small factories can't handle big ones. YuKoLi's flexible production line design resolves this: 4 production bases with differently configured lines, from lab-scale pilot lines (500-5,000 units/batch) to standard production lines (100,000-500,000 units/month) to high-speed lines (500,000-2,000,000 units/month) - enabling seamless capacity transition. Multi-base parallel production can double capacity within 72 hours, ensuring brands never miss a sales window. For seasonal products (winter wellness drinks, summer meal replacement shakes), brands can lock capacity 6 months in advance with YuKoLi's year-round flexible scheduling.



Packaging & Logistics: Multi-Format + Global Delivery

In the powdered beverage space, packaging format directly impacts consumer purchase decisions. YuKoLi offers 7 standard packaging options: single-serve stick pack (15-20g, the classic on-the-go format), double pack (30-40g), canister (300-500g), box (12-20 sticks/box), stand-up pouch (moisture-proof), small sachet (3-5g, for sampling/marketing), and custom-shaped packaging (brand-exclusive visual design). For global logistics, YuKoLi provides sea freight, air freight, and express courier options, supporting DDP (Delivered Duty Paid) terms - brands don't need to handle import customs clearance or tariff payments independently. Typical transit times: 5-7 days within Asia (land/sea), 15-20 days to North America (sea), 15-25 days to Europe (sea). Every export order comes with complete customs documentation (Certificate of Origin, Health Certificate, FDA Registration Letter, Certificate of Analysis).



Quality Control: Full-Chain Management System

Quality management is not an isolated QC function - it is an end-to-end system spanning from raw materials to finished products. YuKoLi operates a four-stage quality control framework: IQC (Incoming Quality Control) - every batch tested for pesticide residues, heavy metals, microbiology, and authenticity; non-conforming materials are rejected with zero concessions. IPQC (In-Process Quality Control) - 12 Critical Control Points (CCPs) during production with online testing for blend uniformity, moisture content, and microbial indicators. OQC (Outgoing Quality Control) - 200+ test parameters covering physical-chemical, microbiological, sensory, and packaging integrity. Shipment inspection - every batch retained for minimum 3 years with full lifecycle traceability. Brands can use YuKoLi's traceability system to query raw material sources, production timing, QC reports, and logistics history for each batch. This system not only ensures product quality but serves as a mandatory requirement for entering major retail chains (Walmart, Costco, CVS).



Choosing Your Model: OEM vs ODM vs OBM

When choosing a manufacturing model, brands must balance control, investment, and speed-to-market. OEM (Original Equipment Manufacturing) - brand provides complete formula and specifications; the OEM produces to standard. Ideal for brands with existing formulas, offering maximum control but highest upfront R&D investment; 30-45 days from order to delivery. ODM (Original Design Manufacturing) - brand provides a concept direction (e.g., a sleep-aid drink with GABA); the OEM handles formula development, sampling, and production. Ideal for startups or rapid testing, with minimum investment but formula ownership residing with the manufacturer (negotiable buyout); 3-7 day sampling + 30-40 day production. OBM (Original Brand Manufacturing) - brand selects from the OEM's existing product portfolio, changing only packaging design. Ideal for e-commerce sellers and livestream commerce teams, offering fastest time-to-market (15-25 days) but lowest product differentiation. Strategic recommendation: Phase 1 (market testing) ? choose OBM for rapid validation. Phase 2 (data confirmed) ? switch to ODM for differentiated formulations. Phase 3 (brand established) ? upgrade to OEM to own core formulas.

About YuKoLi



YuKoLi is a Foshan-based health food OEM/ODM manufacturing group with 20+ years of expertise, 4 automated production bases, and a 50+ member PhD-led R&D team. We hold multiple international certifications including FDA, HACCP, ISO 22000, BRC, and Halal, and export to 30+ countries. From formula development to finished product delivery, packaging design to global logistics, YuKoLi provides end-to-end customized manufacturing solutions. Our clients range from startup brands and cross-border e-commerce sellers to retail chains and multinational food corporations. Whatever stage your brand is at, YuKoLi can match the right cooperation model and capacity solution.

Get Started Today

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